

COMMUNITY MARKETPLACE

Financial Projection Report

Founder-Led Build — Irish Market — 2026

Report Date: 02 July 2026

Solo senior engineer build · AI-assisted development

Executive Summary

This report projects the financial performance of the Community Marketplace platform under a founder-led build model. The platform was developed by a senior software engineer using AI-assisted tooling (Cursor Pro), with minimal cash outlay beyond subscriptions and infrastructure — not a traditional agency or hired-team engagement.

Codebase scale: ~239,000 lines of TypeScript, 67 API controllers, 134+ services, 122+ web routes, ~50 database models, and 20 domain modules — equivalent to 12,380–18,590 hours (15,485 hrs midpoint) of conventional development effort.

Your Actual Costs (Primary Model)

Cost Item	Amount	Notes
One-time development cost	€10,000	Cursor Pro, tools, domains during build; founder time not cash-costed
Annual operating cost (fixed)	€1,500	VPS, domain, email, SMS/OTP, marketing — all-in
Monthly operating cost (fixed)	€125.00	Excl. variable Stripe fees on revenue
Weekly operating cost (fixed)	€28.85	
Daily operating cost (fixed)	€4.11	
Variable Stripe processing	~2.9% of platform revenue	On transaction fees and SKU purchases collected via Stripe
Staff / salaries	€0	Founder-operated; no hired team in base model

Market Replacement Value (Reference Only)

If this same platform were built by an Irish agency from scratch, the estimated replacement cost would be €1,316,225 (midpoint at €85/hr). Your actual spend of €10,000 represents a 99.2% reduction vs market rates — achieved through founder expertise and AI-assisted development.

The platform significantly exceeds a typical MVP — it includes enterprise-grade RBAC, Stripe Connect payments, real-time chat, fraud detection, monetization SKUs, PDF financial reporting, seller KYC, and a unified admin/super-admin panel with 46+ pages.

1. Methodology & Irish Market Benchmarks

1.1 Rate Sources (2026)

Role / Engagement	Rate Range	Source
Junior freelance developer	€30–€50/hr	Abbacus Technologies, IT Search 2026
Mid-level freelance developer	€50–€80/hr	Abbacus Technologies, IT Search 2026
Senior freelance / specialist	€80–€150/hr	Abbacus Technologies, SalarySavvy Dublin
Full-stack contractor (day rate)	€450–€650/day	IT Search Ireland 2026
Irish SME agency (blended)	€85–€120/hr	Industry standard markup on contractor rates
Premium Dublin agency	€120–€200/hr	PayMetric Labs, agency benchmarks
QA engineer	€45–€65/hr	IT Search Ireland 2026
UX/UI designer	€55–€85/hr	SalarySavvy Dublin 2026
DevOps engineer	€80–€120/hr	SalarySavvy Dublin 2026

1.2 Estimation Approach

Feature hours were estimated by auditing actual controllers, services, Prisma models, and frontend components in the monorepo. Section 2 lists every implemented feature with conventional hour estimates for reference. Your actual development cost of €10,000 covers AI tooling subscriptions and incidental build costs; founder engineering time is not cash-costed in this model.

1.3 Codebase Metrics

Metric	Value
Total TypeScript/TSX lines	~239,201
API controllers	67
Domain services	134+
Frontend routes	122+
Prisma database models	~50
API domain modules	20
Shared Zod schemas	19
Event listeners	14
Meilisearch indexes	4
Documentation files	89
Default platform transaction fee	10%
Verified seller fee	8%
Monetization SKUs configured	10

2. Complete Feature Inventory

Every implemented feature and sub-feature in the platform, with conventional development hour estimates. These hours reflect market effort — your actual cash cost for the entire build is €10,000 regardless of feature count.

1. Foundation & Shared Packages

Sub-Feature	Hours (Low–High)	Hours (Mid)
Monorepo scaffold (pnpm workspaces)	40–60	50
Shared types package (30+ modules)	80–120	100
Validation package (19 Zod schemas)	60–90	75
Utils, config, brand packages	50–80	65
UI component library	120–180	150
UI dashboard layout & guards	80–120	100
Documentation skeleton (89 docs)	60–100	80

Domain subtotal: 490–750 hours | Mid: 620 hrs

2. Authentication & Onboarding

Sub-Feature	Hours (Low–High)	Hours (Mid)
Email/password registration	40–60	50
OTP login (email + phone, 5 purposes)	80–120	100
JWT access + refresh token rotation	60–90	75
Email activation flow + templates	40–60	50
Device fingerprinting & login audit	30–50	40
Pending registration staging	30–45	38
Admin invitation onboarding	50–80	65
Profile completion gate	20–30	25
Account deletion request	15–25	20
Web: login, register, activate pages	60–90	75
Onboarding flow UI	40–60	50

Domain subtotal: 465–710 hours | Mid: 588 hrs

3. RBAC & User Roles

Sub-Feature	Hours (Low–High)	Hours (Mid)
4 system roles (super-admin, admin, seller, buyer)	40–60	50
Custom roles CRUD + templates	80–120	100
Per-user permission overrides (GRANT/DENY)	60–90	75
Scoped RBAC delegation (5 scopes)	100–150	125
Role-based dashboard routing	30–45	38
Seller status lifecycle	40–60	50
Business accounts & ambassador program	50–75	62
Seller limits & custom platform fees	40–60	50

Domain subtotal: 440–660 hours | Mid: 550 hrs

4. User Profiles & Settings

Sub-Feature	Hours (Low–High)	Hours (Mid)
Profile CRUD (bio, location, avatar)	50–75	62
R2 presigned upload (avatar, banner)	60–90	75
Phone verification & change OTP	40–60	50
Notification/privacy preferences	40–60	50
Settings pages (buyer/seller/admin)	80–120	100

Domain subtotal: 270–405 hours | Mid: 338 hrs

5. Listings & Marketplace Core

Sub-Feature	Hours (Low–High)	Hours (Mid)
Listing CRUD with 11 lifecycle states	200–300	250
Categories tree & community stats	60–90	75
Image upload, confirm, reorder (R2)	100–150	125
Listing packages (FREE, PAID 7/30/60/90D, PREMIUM)	80–120	100
Duplicate, renew, archive, mark sold	60–90	75
Status history & analytics	50–75	62
Admin review thread (seller ↔ admin)	60–90	75
Auto-moderation & fraud triggers	80–120	100
Listing expiry background job	25–40	32
Public browse, search, feeds, nearby areas	120–180	150
Reverse geocode & delivery options	50–75	62
Similar listings & view tracking	40–60	50
Vehicle listing schema & form (1000+ LOC)	120–180	150
Web: listing detail, browse, filters	200–300	250
Web: seller listing form & management	250–380	315

Domain subtotal: 1,495–2,250 hours | Mid: 1,872 hrs

6. Stores & Storefronts

Sub-Feature	Hours (Low–High)	Hours (Mid)
Multi-store CRUD & slug management	80–120	100
Store branding (logo, banner, policies)	60–90	75
Opening hours & contact settings	40–60	50
Public store page & listings	80–120	100
Store slot monetization integration	50–75	62
Web: storefront components (15+)	120–180	150

Domain subtotal: 430–645 hours | Mid: 538 hrs

7. Delivery & Pricing Workflows

Sub-Feature	Hours (Low–High)	Hours (Mid)
Delivery zones (COLLECTION, LOCAL, NATIONAL, CUSTOM)	80–120	100
Per-listing delivery options	60–90	75
Delivery change review workflow	80–120	100

Pricing preview/update with admin gate	80–120	100
Price change review workflow	80–120	100
Admin delivery & price review pages	60–90	75

Domain subtotal: 440–660 hours | Mid: 550 hrs

8. Search (Meilisearch)

Sub-Feature	Hours (Low–High)	Hours (Mid)
4 indexes (listings, users, categories, chat)	80–120	100
Full-text search with geo-radius filters	80–120	100
Autocomplete & global search	50–75	62
Auto-indexing event listeners	60–90	75
Admin reindex with job status	40–60	50
Search analytics & click tracking	40–60	50
Admin synonyms, stop-words, tuning	60–90	75

Domain subtotal: 410–615 hours | Mid: 512 hrs

9. Chat & Real-Time Messaging

Sub-Feature	Hours (Low–High)	Hours (Mid)
Thread CRUD (per listing + buyer + seller)	80–120	100
Message send/edit/delete/read receipts	80–120	100
Socket.IO gateway (typing, presence)	100–150	125
Image attachments (R2 presigned)	50–75	62
Thread archive & blocking	40–60	50
Legacy messages API compatibility	30–45	38
Chat notifications listener	30–45	38
Web: chat window, inbox, modals	120–180	150

Domain subtotal: 530–795 hours | Mid: 662 hrs

10. Payments & Stripe Connect

Sub-Feature	Hours (Low–High)	Hours (Mid)
Stripe Connect seller onboarding	100–150	125
PaymentIntent + Checkout Session flows	120–180	150
Platform fee calculation & splits	60–90	75
Webhook handler (idempotent events)	80–120	100
Payment completion & settlement	80–120	100
Buyer purchase history & seller sales	60–90	75
PDF receipt generation + email	80–120	100
Stripe dispute handling	60–90	75
Manual payouts & ledger	60–90	75
Web: buy-now, earnings, payments pages	150–220	185

Domain subtotal: 850–1,270 hours | Mid: 1,060 hrs

11. Monetization & Buyer Wallet

Sub-Feature	Hours (Low–High)	Hours (Mid)
Listing boosts (7D/30D) + expiry jobs	80–120	100
Featured homepage/category slots	80–120	100
Fast-track verification purchase	60–90	75
Store slot purchases (2, 3, bundle)	60–90	75
Buyer statement purchase unlock	60–90	75
Cashback grants + cooling period jobs	80–120	100
Buyer wallet & transaction history	60–90	75
Platform purchase invoices (PDF + email)	60–90	75
Admin monetization settings & audit	60–90	75
Web: boost/featured/package dialogs	100–150	125

Domain subtotal: 700–1,050 hours | Mid: 875 hrs

12. Seller Verification (KYC)

Sub-Feature	Hours (Low–High)	Hours (Mid)
Multi-step flow (phone, ID, selfie, address)	150–220	185
Document upload & admin review	80–120	100
Fast-track fulfillment integration	40–60	50
Listing gate for unverified sellers	80–120	100
Status history & admin sub-pages	80–120	100
Web: verification flow UI (470+ LOC)	100–150	125

Domain subtotal: 530–790 hours | Mid: 660 hrs

13. Trust & Reviews

Sub-Feature	Hours (Low–High)	Hours (Mid)
Buyer reviews seller + pending queue	60–90	75
Seller reviews buyer	40–60	50
Trust profiles (buyer + seller)	50–75	62
Trust cues on listings & storefront	40–60	50

Domain subtotal: 190–285 hours | Mid: 238 hrs

14. Disputes

Sub-Feature	Hours (Low–High)	Hours (Mid)
Buyer dispute creation + evidence upload	80–120	100
Dispute timeline & party responses	60–90	75
Admin resolution workflow	60–90	75
Web: buyer/seller/admin dispute pages	80–120	100

Domain subtotal: 280–420 hours | Mid: 350 hrs

15. Fraud Detection

Sub-Feature	Hours (Low–High)	Hours (Mid)
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8 signal types + risk scoring	100–150	125
Keyword, location, duplication checks	80–120	100
Event-driven fraud listener	40–60	50
Admin fraud panel + escalation	60–90	75

Domain subtotal: 280–420 hours | Mid: 350 hrs

16. Moderation

Sub-Feature	Hours (Low–High)	Hours (Mid)
Report users/listings/messages	60–90	75
Appeals workflow	50–75	62
Action types (warn, suspend, ban, delete)	80–120	100
Content check service	40–60	50
Admin moderation analytics	60–90	75
Chat message moderation	60–90	75
Listing moderation queues	80–120	100

Domain subtotal: 430–645 hours | Mid: 538 hrs

17. Notifications

Sub-Feature	Hours (Low–High)	Hours (Mid)
30+ in-app notification types	100–150	125
FCM push + device registration	80–120	100
Email templates with versioning	80–120	100
Per-channel preferences	50–75	62
Admin broadcast & template CRUD	80–120	100
Provider health & delivery logs	60–90	75
Rate limiting service	30–45	38
Event listeners (14 total across modules)	100–150	125

Domain subtotal: 580–870 hours | Mid: 725 hrs

18. Admin Panel (46+ pages)

Sub-Feature	Hours (Low–High)	Hours (Mid)
Dashboard stats & audit log	80–120	100
User management (suspend, ban, verify)	100–150	125
Listing moderation (6 queues)	120–180	150
Seller verification admin (8 sub-pages)	120–180	150
Payments admin (ledger, refunds, disputes)	100–150	125
Finance / platform revenue reports	80–120	100
Search health & reindex admin	60–90	75
Notifications admin	80–120	100
RBAC manager UI (678 LOC)	100–150	125
Admin resource pages (1043 LOC)	150–220	185

Domain subtotal: 990–1,480 hours | Mid: 1,235 hrs

19. Super-Admin

Sub-Feature	Hours (Low–High)	Hours (Mid)
Platform settings CRUD	60–90	75
Full RBAC matrix & admin CRUD	100–150	125

Admin invitations system	80–120	100
Operations controller	60–90	75
Super-admin analytics & audit	60–90	75

Domain subtotal: 360–540 hours | Mid: 450 hrs

20. Finance & Statements

Sub-Feature	Hours (Low–High)	Hours (Mid)
Buyer account statements (paid unlock)	100–150	125
Seller free monthly statements	80–120	100
Platform revenue report service	80–120	100
PDF layouts (statement, revenue, receipts)	150–220	185
CSV/XLSX export utilities	60–90	75
Web: finance pages & export buttons	60–90	75

Domain subtotal: 530–790 hours | Mid: 660 hrs

21. Share & Social

Sub-Feature	Hours (Low–High)	Hours (Mid)
Short link creation & resolution	40–60	50
Share event tracking (8+ channels)	40–60	50
QR code generation	20–30	25
Seller share analytics page	40–60	50

Domain subtotal: 140–210 hours | Mid: 175 hrs

22. Public Web & PWA

Sub-Feature	Hours (Low–High)	Hours (Mid)
Homepage (hero, categories, featured)	80–120	100
Static pages (about, help, safety, terms)	60–90	75
Public layout, header, footer, nav	80–120	100
PWA offline fallback	30–45	38
Service worker recovery	25–40	32

Domain subtotal: 275–415 hours | Mid: 345 hrs

23. Infrastructure & DevOps

Sub-Feature	Hours (Low–High)	Hours (Mid)
Docker Compose (PostgreSQL, Redis, Meilisearch)	40–60	50
Kubernetes overlays & Traefik TLS	80–120	100
Health checks & Prometheus metrics	30–45	38
Job queue service	40–60	50
R2 cleanup background job	25–40	32
Deploy/rollback/backup runbooks	60–90	75
OVH VPS deployment guide	30–45	38

Domain subtotal: 305–460 hours | Mid: 382 hrs

24. Security & Compliance

Sub-Feature	Hours (Low–High)	Hours (Mid)
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HTTP exception filter & interceptors	20–30	25
API security patterns & RBAC guards	60–90	75
Stripe webhook signature verification	20–30	25
GDPR-ready data structures	40–60	50
Security checklist documentation	30–45	38

Domain subtotal: 170–255 hours | Mid: 212 hrs

25. Testing & QA

Sub-Feature	Hours (Low–High)	Hours (Mid)
Unit & integration test coverage	400–600	500
E2E test scaffolding	200–300	250
Manual QA & UAT cycles	200–300	250

Domain subtotal: 800–1,200 hours | Mid: 1,000 hrs

2.1 Development Cost — Your Actual Spend

Item	Estimated Range	Notes
Cursor Pro subscription (build period)	€400–€600	~€20/mo over 18–24 month build
Domain name(s)	€40–€60	Registration + first-year renewal
Dev/staging VPS (during build)	€200–€400	Smaller instance pre-launch
Email service (dev + early prod)	€100–€200	Resend/SendGrid starter
SMS/OTP (Twilio etc., testing)	€150–€300	Phone verification testing
Misc. tools (GitHub, Canva, etc.)	€200–€400	Free tiers + occasional paid
Stripe setup / test transactions	€50–€100	Connect onboarding tests
Contingency / unforeseen	€500–€1,000	Buffer for unexpected tool costs
TOTAL (one-time development)	€10,000	Founder engineering time: not cash-costed

2.2 Market Replacement Value (Reference)

Total conventional effort: 12,380–18,590 hours (mid: 15,485 hrs). If outsourced to an Irish agency at €85/hr, replacement cost would be €1,316,225. Your actual spend is €10,000 — a 99.2% saving.

Agency Scenario (reference)	Hours Range	Hours Mid	Base Cost	With 25% Contingency
Lean Hybrid Team (remote + Irish lead)	12,380–18,590	15,485	€898,130	€1,122,662
Irish SME Agency / Blended Team	12,380–18,590	15,485	€1,316,225	€1,645,281
Premium Dublin Agency	12,380–18,590	15,485	€1,935,625	€2,419,531

3. Marketing Plan (Within €1,500/Year Operating Budget)

Marketing is included in the fixed €1,500/year operating budget (see Section 4). This plan prioritises free organic channels with a small paid allocation, plus founder time (~10–15 hours/week). No separate marketing budget beyond the annual €1,500.

3.1 Annual Marketing Allocation (~€360 of €1,500)

Channel / Activity	Annual Cost	Notes
Google Business Profile optimisation	€0	Free — essential for local SEO
Organic social media (Instagram, Facebook, TikTok)	€0	Founder-led content, 3–5 posts/week
Canva free tier (graphics)	€0	Sufficient at launch; Pro optional
Mailchimp / Brevo free tier	€0	Up to 500 contacts
Targeted Google Ads (local intent)	€180/yr	~€15/mo — high-intent keywords only
Facebook/Instagram boost posts	€120/yr	~€10/mo on best organic posts
Community partnerships	€60/yr	Local events, flyers, GAA/community groups
TOTAL PAID MARKETING	€360/yr	Remaining €1,140 covers infra (Section 4)

3.2 Free & Grant-Funded Activities

Programme	Value	Notes
Trading Online Voucher (LEO)	Up to €2,500 grant	50% co-funding — can offset infra/marketing setup
LEO subsidised training	€50–€200 per course	Social media, SEO, digital analytics programmes
Local Enterprise Office mentoring	Free	1:1 business mentor for go-to-market
Referral / ambassador programme	€0 cash	Built into platform — community ambassador feature
PR & local media	€0	Press releases to local radio, regional papers
SEO content (blog, guides)	€0	Founder-written 'how to sell safely in Ireland' guides

3.3 Year 1 Marketing Calendar

Period	Focus
Month 1–2	Setup GBP, social profiles, LEO grant application, launch PR
Month 3–4	Organic SEO content, 2 community events, start €15/mo Google Ads
Month 5–6	Referral programme launch, county-by-county organic posts
Month 7–8	Retargeting via free Facebook tools, local partnership outreach
Month 9–10	Back-to-school / pre-Christmas seller campaigns (organic)
Month 11–12	Holiday peak push, year-in-review content, case studies

4. Annual Operating Costs (€1,500 Fixed + Variable Stripe)

Founder-led model: no staff salaries, no office, no agency fees. Fixed annual cost is €1,500 covering all infrastructure and services. Stripe payment processing fees are variable (~2.9% of platform-collected revenue).

4.1 Annual Fixed Cost Breakdown (€1,500)

Item	Annual (€)	Notes
VPS hosting (OVH / similar)	€420	€35/mo — API, PostgreSQL, Redis, Meilisearch
Domain + SSL	€20	Annual .ie or .com renewal
Email delivery (Resend/SendGrid)	€180	€15/mo — activation, receipts, notifications
SMS / OTP (Twilio etc.)	€240	€20/mo — login, verification, phone change
Object storage (Cloudflare R2)	€60	~50GB listing images
Marketing (paid + tools)	€360	See Section 3.1
Monitoring & misc tools	€220	Sentry free tier, uptime checks, GitHub
TOTAL FIXED ANNUAL	€1,500	Excl. variable Stripe fees

4.2 Weekly & Daily Breakdowns (Fixed OpEx)

Period	Fixed Operating Cost
Daily	€4.11
Weekly	€28.85
Monthly	€125.00
Quarterly	€375.00
Annual	€1,500

4.3 Variable Stripe Fees (Scales with Revenue)

Stripe charges approximately 2.9% + €0.25 per transaction on platform-collected revenue (transaction fees and SKU purchases). Seller payouts via Stripe Connect have separate pass-through fees. Year 1 estimate at projected revenue: see Section 6 P&L tables.

5. Revenue Model

Revenue streams implemented in the platform:

Stream	Price	Description
Platform transaction fee	10% default (8% verified sellers)	On in-platform card payments via Stripe Connect
Listing boost (7 days)	€1.99	Increased visibility for 7 days
Listing boost (30 days)	€4.99	Increased visibility for 30 days
Featured homepage slot	€2.99/day	8 slots/day maximum
Featured category slot	€1.99/day	4 slots/day per category
Fast-track verification	€2.99	Priority KYC review
Store slot 2	€4.99	Additional storefront
Store slot 3	€4.99	Third storefront
Store bundle (3 slots)	€7.99	Discounted multi-slot
Buyer account statement	€0.99	Monthly PDF/CSV/XLSX unlock
Cashback programme	Cost centre	1.5% cashback — retention tool, not revenue
Display advertising (future)	CPM €5–€15	Not yet implemented — Phase 4+

5.1 Key Assumptions

Assumption	Value	Basis
Development cost (one-time)	€10,000	Founder-led + Cursor Pro; time not cash-costed
Annual fixed operating cost	€1,500	VPS, domain, email, SMS, marketing
Staff / salaries	€0	Founder-operated in base model
Average transaction value	€75	Irish classifieds market average
In-platform payment adoption	25% → 55%	Grows as trust builds (Years 1–10)
Platform fee on GMV	10%	Configurable per seller
Stripe fee on platform revenue	2.9%	Variable cost on collected revenue
Seller monetization conversion	3–8% of active sellers	Boosts, featured, store slots
Irish classifieds market	DoneDeal: 6.4M monthly visitors	Distilled Ltd 2024 results

6. Profit & Loss Projection (2026–2035)

Founder-led financial model. Fixed operating cost is €1,500/year plus variable Stripe fees (~2.9% of platform revenue). One-time development cost of €10,000 is shown separately in Section 2 — not repeated in annual OpEx. No staff salaries. Revenue growth assumptions unchanged from conservative Irish marketplace projections.

Year	MAU	GMV	Revenue	OpEx	Net P/L	Cumulative P/L*
2026	2,500	€120,000	€5,400	€1,657	€3,743	€-6,257
2027	12,000	€680,000	€35,040	€2,516	€32,524	€26,267
2028	32,000	€2,100,000	€125,100	€5,128	€119,972	€146,239
2029	65,000	€5,200,000	€336,800	€11,267	€325,533	€471,772
2030	110,000	€10,500,000	€733,500	€22,772	€710,728	€1,182,501
2031	165,000	€17,200,000	€1,253,000	€37,837	€1,215,163	€2,397,664
2032	220,000	€24,800,000	€1,866,400	€55,626	€1,810,774	€4,208,438
2033	280,000	€33,500,000	€2,571,000	€76,059	€2,494,941	€6,703,379
2034	340,000	€42,000,000	€3,358,000	€98,882	€3,259,118	€9,962,497
2035	400,000	€51,000,000	€4,242,000	€124,518	€4,117,482	€14,079,979

*Cumulative P/L includes one-time development cost of €10,000 in the starting balance.

6.1 P&L Monthly Breakdown by Year

Year	Rev/Month	OpEx/Month	Net/Month	Net/Week	Net/Day
2026	€450.00	€138.05	€311.95	€71.99	€10.26
2027	€2,920.00	€209.68	€2,710.32	€625.46	€89.11
2028	€10,425.00	€427.32	€9,997.68	€2,307.16	€328.69
2029	€28,066.67	€938.93	€27,127.73	€6,260.25	€891.87
2030	€61,125.00	€1,897.62	€59,227.38	€13,667.86	€1,947.20
2031	€104,416.67	€3,153.08	€101,263.58	€23,368.52	€3,329.21
2032	€155,533.33	€4,635.47	€150,897.87	€34,822.58	€4,961.03
2033	€214,250.00	€6,338.25	€207,911.75	€47,979.63	€6,835.45
2034	€279,833.33	€8,240.17	€271,593.17	€62,675.35	€8,929.09
2035	€353,500.00	€10,376.50	€343,123.50	€79,182.35	€11,280.77

6.2 Revenue Breakdown by Source (Annual)

Year	Transaction Fees	SKU Sales	Advertising	Total Revenue
2026	€3,000	€2,400	€0	€5,400
2027	€19,040	€14,000	€2,000	€35,040
2028	€65,100	€48,000	€12,000	€125,100
2029	€176,800	€125,000	€35,000	€336,800
2030	€388,500	€265,000	€80,000	€733,500
2031	€688,000	€420,000	€145,000	€1,253,000
2032	€1,066,400	€580,000	€220,000	€1,866,400
2033	€1,541,000	€720,000	€310,000	€2,571,000
2034	€2,058,000	€880,000	€420,000	€3,358,000
2035	€2,652,000	€1,050,000	€540,000	€4,242,000

6.3 Cost Breakdown by Category (Annual)

Year	Fixed OpEx	Stripe Fees	Total OpEx	OpEx/Month	OpEx/Week
2026	€1,500	€157	€1,657	€138.05	€31.86
2027	€1,500	€1,016	€2,516	€209.68	€48.39
2028	€1,500	€3,628	€5,128	€427.32	€98.61
2029	€1,500	€9,767	€11,267	€938.93	€216.68

2030	€1,500	€21,272	€22,772	€1,897.62	€437.91
2031	€1,500	€36,337	€37,837	€3,153.08	€727.63
2032	€1,500	€54,126	€55,626	€4,635.47	€1,069.72
2033	€1,500	€74,559	€76,059	€6,338.25	€1,462.67
2034	€1,500	€97,382	€98,882	€8,240.17	€1,901.58
2035	€1,500	€123,018	€124,518	€10,376.50	€2,394.58

Operating break-even year: 2026 (annual revenue exceeds annual OpEx). Full payback (incl. €10,000 development cost): 2027. Cumulative position at end of 2035: €14,079,979.

7. Five-Year Summary (2026–2030)

Year	Revenue	OpEx	Net P/L	Rev/Month	Net/Month
2026	€5,400	€1,657	€3,743	€450.00	€311.95
2027	€35,040	€2,516	€32,524	€2,920.00	€2,710.32
2028	€125,100	€5,128	€119,972	€10,425.00	€9,997.68
2029	€336,800	€11,267	€325,533	€28,066.67	€27,127.73
2030	€733,500	€22,772	€710,728	€61,125.00	€59,227.38

7.1 Total Investment vs Return (5-Year)

Metric	Value
One-time development	€10,000
5-year operating costs	€43,339
Total cash invested (5 yr)	€53,339
5-year total revenue	€1,235,840
5-year net profit (after OpEx)	€1,192,501
5-year return incl. dev cost	€1,182,501
ROI on cash invested (5 yr)	2217%

8. Future Development Roadmap

Future features from docs/product/roadmap.md. Under the founder-led model, new features are built using the same AI-assisted approach — incremental tooling cost only, founder time not cash-costed. Agency costs shown for reference.

Initiative	Description	Target	Agency Hours	Agency Cost	Your Est. Cash
Phase 4 — Multi-tenancy	Community/neighborhood scopes, white-label	Q2 2027	1,200–1,800	€127,500	~€2,550
Native mobile apps (iOS + Android)	React Native or Flutter apps	Q3 2027	2,400–3,600	€255,000	~€5,100
Advanced analytics dashboard	Seller insights, cohort analysis, funnels	Q4 2027	600–900	€63,750	~€1,275
GDPR data export & deletion tooling	Automated compliance workflows	Q1 2028	400–600	€42,500	~€850
Public API & partner webhooks	Third-party integrations SDK	Q2 2028	800–1,200	€85,000	~€1,700
AI listing descriptions & moderation	LLM-assisted content generation/review	Q3 2028	600–1,000	€68,000	~€1,360
Escrow & buyer protection fund	Held funds until delivery confirmed	Q4 2028	1,000–1,500	€106,250	~€2,125
Shipping integrations (An Post, DPD)	Label generation & tracking	Q1 2029	800–1,200	€85,000	~€1,700
Auction/bidding system	Timed auctions for high-value items	Q2 2029	1,000–1,500	€106,250	~€2,125
B2B dealer portal	Bulk listings, inventory sync, CRM	Q3 2029	1,500–2,200	€157,250	~€3,145
International expansion (UK)	Multi-currency, cross-border compliance	Q4 2029	2,000–3,000	€212,500	~€4,250
Video listings &	Short-form video, live	2029–2030	1,800–2,600	€187,000	~€3,740

live selling	stream commerce				
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Total future agency equivalent: 14,100–21,100 hours | Agency cost: €1,496,000 | Your estimated incremental cash (tools/subscriptions): ~€29,920 over the roadmap period.

9. Development Cost — Time-Based Breakdowns

Your one-time development investment of €10,000 over an estimated 18-month build period (founder evenings/weekends + AI-assisted coding):

Metric	Value
Total cash development cost	€10,000
Monthly cash burn (dev period)	€555.56
Weekly cash burn (dev period)	€128.30
Daily cash burn (dev period, 5-day wk)	€25.25
Conventional hours delivered	15,485 hrs
Market equivalent cost	€1,316,225
Your saving vs market	€1,306,225
Build model	Solo senior engineer + Cursor Pro

10. Risk Factors & Sensitivities

Risk	Severity	Mitigation
Market dominance of DoneDeal/Adverts.ie	High	Differentiate on community, trust, local focus
Slow in-platform payment adoption	High	Buyer protection incentives, cashback programme
Founder bandwidth / key-person risk	High	Document architecture; automate ops; hire when revenue allows
Regulatory (PSD2, consumer rights)	Medium	Stripe handles most payment compliance
VPS capacity at scale	Medium	Upgrade hosting when MAU exceeds ~50K; cost still modest
Cybersecurity incident	Medium	Keep dependencies updated; enable Stripe fraud tools
Revenue below projections	Medium	Lean €1,500/yr cost base keeps runway very long

Appendix A: Irish Market Context

Benchmark	Value	Source
DoneDeal monthly visitors	6.4 million	Distilled Ltd 2024
Adverts.ie monthly users	~2 million	Distilled Ltd 2024
Adverts.ie new listings/month	200,000+	Distilled Ltd 2024
Distilled Ltd revenue (2024)	€47 million	RTE / filed accounts
Distilled Ltd pre-tax profit (2024)	€7.55 million	Down 38% YoY
Typical Irish agency project (marketplace)	€500K–€2M	Industry benchmarks
LEO Trading Online Voucher	Up to €2,500	50% co-funded
Minimum viable marketing (Ireland)	€500–€1,000/mo	ProfileTree, BeFound 2026

Appendix B: Default Platform Pricing (from codebase)

SKU / Setting	Default Price
boost_7d	€1.99
boost_30d	€4.99
featured_homepage	€2.99
featured_category	€1.99

fast_track_verification	€2.99
store_slot_2	€4.99
store_slot_3	€4.99
store_bundle_3	€7.99
buyer_statement	€0.99
platform_fee_default	10%
verified_seller_fee	8%
cashback	1.5%

Appendix C: Glossary of Abbreviations

All abbreviations and acronyms used in this report, grouped by category.

Financial & Business Terms

Abbreviation	Full meaning & context in this report
MAU	Monthly Active Users — unique users who visit or use the platform at least once in a calendar month. Key growth metric.
GMV	Gross Merchandise Value — total euro value of all goods/services sold through the platform in a period, before fees and refunds.
OpEx	Operating Expenses — day-to-day running costs. In this report: €1,500/year fixed (VPS, domain, email, SMS, marketing) plus variable Stripe fees.
P&L / P/L	Profit and Loss — financial statement showing revenue minus costs; net result is profit or loss.
SKU	Stock Keeping Unit — a distinct paid product or service (e.g. 7-day listing boost, featured slot). Each SKU has its own price.
CPM	Cost Per Mille — advertising cost per 1,000 impressions (views) of an ad.
SME	Small and Medium Enterprise — Irish/EU classification for businesses below large-corporate size; used for agency and grant context.
MVP	Minimum Viable Product — smallest feature set needed to launch and test with real users.
FTE	Full-Time Equivalent — one person working full-time; e.g. '5–6 FTE' means a team of five to six full-time developers.
YoY	Year over Year — comparison of a metric in one year vs the same period in the previous year.
B2B	Business to Business — selling tools or services to other businesses (e.g. dealer portal) rather than consumers.
CRM	Customer Relationship Management — software for managing customer/dealer contacts and sales pipelines.
Ltd	Limited — Irish/UK private company structure (e.g. Distilled Ltd); shareholders' liability is limited to their investment.
NFP	Not-for-Profit — organisation structure that may qualify for schemes like Google Ad Grants.
PSD2	Payment Services Directive 2 — EU regulation governing electronic payments, strong customer authentication, and open banking.

Revenue & Cost Line Items

Abbreviation	Full meaning & context in this report
Transaction fee revenue	Platform's cut (default 10%) on sales paid through in-platform Stripe payments.
SKU revenue	Income from sellers/buyers purchasing paid add-ons (boosts, featured slots, verification fast-track, etc.).
Stripe cost	Payment processing fees charged by Stripe (typically ~1.4% + €0.25 per card transaction in Ireland).
Infra + Tools	Infrastructure (servers, storage) plus software subscriptions (monitoring, email, GitHub, etc.).
Cumulative P/L	Running total of net profit/loss from launch year through each projection year.
Break-even	Point where annual revenue equals or exceeds operating expenses (operating profit ≥ 0).
Contingency	Extra budget buffer (report uses 25%) for scope creep, delays, and unknowns.

Marketing & Irish Programmes

Abbreviation	Full meaning & context in this report
LEO	Local Enterprise Office — Irish government network offering grants, mentoring, and training to small businesses in every county.
Trading Online Voucher	LEO grant of up to €2,500 (50% matched by you) for e-commerce, website, SEO, and digital marketing.
GBP	Google Business Profile — free Google listing for local search and maps visibility (formerly Google My Business).
SEO	Search Engine Optimisation — improving organic (unpaid) ranking in Google and other search engines.
PR	Public Relations — media outreach, press releases, and coverage in newspapers, radio, and online.
GAA	Gaelic Athletic Association — Ireland's largest community sports body; useful for local partnership marketing.
RTE	Raidió Teilifís Éireann — Ireland's national public broadcaster (TV and radio).
mo	Per month — e.g. €500/mo = €500 per month.
hr / hrs	Hour(s) — used for developer rates and time estimates.

Technology — Platform & Architecture

Abbreviation	Full meaning & context in this report
API	Application Programming Interface — backend endpoints the web and mobile apps call to read/write data.
REST	Representational State Transfer — standard style for HTTP APIs (GET, POST, PATCH, DELETE).
JWT	JSON Web Token — secure token format for login sessions and API authentication.
OTP	One-Time Password — short code sent by email or SMS for login, registration, or verification.
RBAC	Role-Based Access Control — permissions tied to roles (buyer, seller, admin) rather than hard-coded per user.
KYC	Know Your Customer — identity verification process (ID, selfie, address) for sellers.
CRUD	Create, Read, Update, Delete — basic data operations

	for any entity (listings, users, etc.).
SDK	Software Development Kit — packaged tools for third parties to integrate with your platform.
Webhook	Automated HTTP callback — e.g. Stripe notifying your server when a payment succeeds.

Technology — Frontend & UX

Abbreviation	Full meaning & context in this report
UI	User Interface — visual elements users interact with (buttons, forms, tables).
UX	User Experience — overall ease and quality of using the product.
PWA	Progressive Web App — website that can work offline and be installed like an app on phones.
TS / TSX	TypeScript / TypeScript + JSX — programming languages used across this codebase.
LOC	Lines of Code — rough measure of codebase size (~239,000 in this project).

Technology — Infrastructure & Services

Abbreviation	Full meaning & context in this report
DevOps	Development Operations — practices and tooling for deploying, monitoring, and scaling software.
VPS	Virtual Private Server — rented cloud server (e.g. OVH) hosting the API and databases.
K8s	Kubernetes — container orchestration for scaling multiple services in production.
TLS	Transport Layer Security — encryption for HTTPS (padlock in the browser).
R2	Cloudflare R2 — object storage for images and files (similar to AWS S3).
FCM	Firebase Cloud Messaging — Google's push notification service for mobile and web.
CDN	Content Delivery Network — geographically distributed cache for faster image and static file delivery.
HPA	Horizontal Pod Autoscaler — Kubernetes feature that adds/removes server instances based on load.
OVH	French cloud/hosting provider commonly used for EU-based VPS deployments.

Technology — Data & Documents

Abbreviation	Full meaning & context in this report
PDF	Portable Document Format — downloadable receipts, statements, and revenue reports.
CSV	Comma-Separated Values — spreadsheet-friendly export format for financial data.
XLSX	Microsoft Excel Open XML — Excel workbook format for statement and report exports.
GDPR	General Data Protection Regulation — EU privacy law governing personal data collection and user rights.

Technology — Testing & Quality

Abbreviation	Full meaning & context in this report
QA	Quality Assurance — systematic testing to find bugs before release.

UAT	User Acceptance Testing — final testing with real or representative users before go-live.
E2E	End-to-End — automated tests that simulate a full user journey through the app.

Technology — AI & Future Features

Abbreviation	Full meaning & context in this report
LLM	Large Language Model — AI systems (e.g. GPT) used for auto-generating listing text or moderation assist.
AI/ML	Artificial Intelligence / Machine Learning.

Vehicle Listings (Irish Context)

Abbreviation	Full meaning & context in this report
NCT	National Car Test — Ireland's mandatory periodic vehicle roadworthiness certificate.
VIN	Vehicle Identification Number — unique 17-character ID for every motor vehicle.

Payment & Compliance

Abbreviation	Full meaning & context in this report
Stripe Connect	Stripe's marketplace product — splits payments between platform and sellers, handles payouts.
PaymentIntent	Stripe object representing a single card payment attempt.
Express dashboard	Stripe-hosted portal where sellers view payouts and tax documents.

Time & Project Planning

Abbreviation	Full meaning & context in this report
Q1–Q4	Calendar quarters — Q1 = Jan–Mar, Q2 = Apr–Jun, Q3 = Jul–Sep, Q4 = Oct–Dec.
Mid	Midpoint estimate — average of low and high range in hour/cost tables.
Low / High	Optimistic vs pessimistic bounds on hours or cost estimates.

Appendix D: Disclaimer

This report uses a founder-led cost model: €10,000 one-time development and €1,500/year fixed operating costs, plus variable Stripe fees. Founder engineering time is not cash-costed. Agency replacement values are included for comparison only. P&L projections are conservative models — not financial advice. Revenue assumptions should be validated with pilot launch data.